

Webbkoll and ICO findings

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This briefing records the measurements and lawful-basis results I produced for the group assignment. Part A is Webbkoll. Part B is the ICO tool. The two parts answer different questions and are not mixed.

A. Webbkoll findings

Tool: English Webbkoll. One live Chromium visit, no add-ons, Do Not Track off, cookie banner not clicked. Server country is the KeyCDN Country field. Norway is excluded from the country count. Table 2 is the first measurement on 20 August 2026. Table 3 is the repeat measurement.

Webbkoll reports HTTPS, cookies, third-party requests and the server IP. It does not read a privacy notice and it does not decide Article 6.

A1. Sites I measured: skatteetaten.no and netflix.no

Service	Measurement	Server	Int.	Ext.	Req.	n countries	Country list
skatteetaten.no	First (20 Aug 2026)	CA	5	0	14	5	IE, SE, FR, GB, NO, CA
skatteetaten.no	Repeat (20 Aug 2026)	US	5	0	14	4	FR, IE, SE, US
netflix.no	First (20 Aug 2026)	GB	6	0	22	2	GB, CA
netflix.no	Repeat (20 Aug 2026)	US	6	0	22	1	US

Int. = internal cookies. Ext. = external cookies. Req. = third-party requests. n countries excludes Norway.

- skatteetaten.no: 14 third-party requests, 5 first-party cookies, 0 third-party cookies. Request volume is stable between the two measurements. The server country field changes from CA to US.
- netflix.no: 22 third-party requests, 6 first-party cookies, 0 third-party cookies. Request volume is stable. The server country field changes from GB to US. The repeat country list shrinks to US only.
- Neither site set a third-party cookie on load. Contact with other hosts is visible in the request count, not in the external-cookie count.

A2. Group Table 2 (first measurement of all 18 sites)

These are the first-clock values used in the joint report. Rankings in the paper follow this table, not the repeat clock.

Service	Sector	Server	Int.	Ext.	Req.	n countries
xxl.no	Shopping	US	3	0	26	4
cdon.no	Shopping	CA	4	0	33	3
ikea.no	Shopping	CA	8	2	15	2
babyshop.no	Shopping	CA	1	0	45	2
skatteetaten.no	Government	CA	5	0	14	5
barnevernet.no	Government	NO	2	0	25	4
altinn.no	Government	CA	0	0	5	1
lanekassen.no	Government	NL	0	0	1	1
aftenposten.no	News / media	SE	5	0	48	5
nrk.no	News / media	SE	10	0	7	1
netflix.no	News / media	GB	6	0	22	2
document.no	News / media	DE	4	0	51	6
klassekampen.no	News / media	US	4	0	46	2
spotify.no	News / media	US	3	0	10	2
worldofwarcraft.com	News / media	IE	4	0	90	4
dnt.no	Sport	GB	6	0	16	4
fotball.no	Sport	NL	8	0	113	5
skiforeningen.no	Sport	SE	1	0	14	3

A3. Pattern from the Webbkoll set

- Highest request counts: fotball.no 113, worldofwarcraft.com 90, document.no 51, afternposten.no 48, klassekampen.no 46.
- Lowest request counts: lanekassen.no 1, altinn.no 5, nrk.no 7, spotify.no 10, skiforeningen.no 14.
- ikea.no is the only site with third-party cookies (2), after redirect to ikea.com.
- fotball.no has the highest request count and still 0 third-party cookies. Request volume is not cookie volume.
- document.no has the widest first country list (6, excluding Norway).
- By sector, news and media contact the most hosts. Government contacts the fewest. Shopping sits between those extremes.
- On the repeat clock, babyshop.no rises from 45 to 101 requests and klassekampen.no from 46 to 56. Rankings still follow the first measurement.

B. ICO findings

Tool: ICO Lawful basis interactive guidance (updated 14 April 2026). Official Word reports dated 26 August 2026. One concrete purpose per run. Recognised legitimate interest fitted none of these purposes.

Article 6 answers why personal data may be processed. Cookie rules answer whether information may be stored on a device. Mixing the two in one ICO run returns the wrong basis.

B1. skatteetaten.no: tax and the National Population Register

- **Purpose:** identity, income and tax data for tax administration and the National Population Register.
- **Not included:** Skyra, Matomo, Google Analytics, Siteimprove.
- **Notice:** processing is required by law. Opt-out is generally not possible. Controller: the Director General of Taxation.
- **ICO result:** legal obligation APPROPRIATE; public task APPROPRIATE; consent NOT APPROPRIATE / likely invalid; other bases NOT APPROPRIATE.
- **Match:** Yes
- **Report:** Skatteetaten_Lawful basis assessment report.docx

B2. skatteetaten.no: optional statistics cookies

- **Purpose:** optional statistics cookies after the Yes/No choice.
- **Not included:** tax and registry processing.
- **Notice / banner:** necessary cookies stay on. Optional cookies can be refused. No was selected on 24 August 2026 on skatteetaten.no/person/.
- **ICO result:** consent INCONCLUSIVE. The banner does not fully name controller, purpose and types. No basis APPROPRIATE.
- **Match:** Partial. The notice aims at consent. The ICO report says the request is too thin.
- **Report:** Skatteetaten_cookies_Lawful basis assessment report.docx

A Yes/No banner does not decide whether the Tax Administration may process income data. Tax and cookies are two purposes and two ICO reports.

B3. netflix.no: paid streaming

- **Purpose:** account and payment data to provide the paid subscription.
- **Not included:** recommendations, advertising, marketing.
- **Notice (EEA/UK):** contractual necessity to provide the service to members. Last updated 10 April 2026.
- **ICO result:** contract APPROPRIATE; consent NOT APPROPRIATE / likely invalid (no genuine ongoing choice); other bases NOT APPROPRIATE.
- **Match:** Yes
- **Report:** Netflix_Lawful basis assessment report.docx

B4. Remaining ICO runs in the joint table

These three runs complete Table 5. They were not my ICO files, but they sit next to the rows above in the group report.

Service	Purpose	ICO result	Match
fotball.no	Publishing player name and club (13+) as match history	Legitimate interests APPROPRIATE	Yes
document.no	Google Signals / advertising analytics	Consent INCONCLUSIVE; no basis APPROPRIATE	Partial
babyshop.no	Checkout and delivery data	Contract APPROPRIATE	Yes

B5. ICO summary

- Four of five core purposes match the notice: law for tax, contract for Netflix and Babyshop checkout, legitimate interests for NFF match history.
- Two consent tests fail: optional cookies on skatteetaten.no, and Google Signals on document.no.
- Cookie consent is not the lawful basis for tax, a paid subscription, match history or checkout.

Sources: Webbkoll (5th of July Foundation); KeyCDN IP Location Finder; ICO lawful basis tool; Tax Administration privacy policy; Netflix Privacy Statement.